went out to dinner.

As for David Starr: Space Ranger, I worked on that almost every moment I wasn't working on the textbook. It went quickly, and on July 29, it was done. I sent a copy to Brad and another to Fred the next day.

Sometime toward the end of August was baby day, and we were rather desperate to have some sort of vacation before that came. We were afraid to get away from the city for too long a period in case of

7 By now, the Korean War was a year old and, with the failure of MacArthur's bid for victory, extremely unpopular. Truce negotiations were under way.

emergency, but we managed to go to New York over the July 14-17 weekend.

We seized at any nondistant, nonlong trip we could make. There was an annual picnic at Dean Faulkner's estate, for instance, and we went to that. The estate was very close to a summer resort, and I managed to eat three lobsters.

Then on August 4, we made a motor trip to Rockport, which was not very far from Camp Annisquam. Rockport is a quaint old fishing village, carefully designed as a tourist trap, but we liked wandering through its stores, even though we rarely bought anything. We repeated the trip periodically in later times.

15

It's not surprising that friends of mine tried to write science-fiction stories. If I could do it, after all, surely anyone could.

It was pleasant that some of them succeeded. The Boyds were a case in point. Another was Armin Deutsch, then a Harvard astronomer and one of the Decadents. He called me up one day and said he was writing a science-fiction story. Could he read me the beginning?

"Go ahead," I said, in resignation.

He read a few paragraphs and I grew excited. "Let me see the rest," I said. "It sounds good."

The next time we met he gave me the manuscript. I read it, and said, "Send it to Campbell. He'll take it."